

BEGINNING OF GANDHIAN ERA

Mahatma Gandhi (1869-1948)

Early Life and Influences

- **Date of Birth:** October 2, 1869, in **Porbandar, Gujarat**
- **Parents:** Father - Karamchand Gandhi; Mother - Putali Bai
- **Political Guru:** Gopal Krishna Gokhale
- **Literary Influences:** **John Ruskin** - *Unto This Last*; **Emerson** and **Thoreau** - *Civil Disobedience & The Bible and The Gita*
- **Literary Works:** *Hind Swaraj* (1909), *My Experiments with Truth* (Autobiography), **Asian Editor:** *Indian Opinion* (1903-15), *Harijan* (1919-31), *Young India* (1933-42) & **'Song from Prison'** a translation of ancient Indian religious lyrics in English. [UPSC 2021]
- **Other Names:** Mahatma (Saint) - by **Rabindranath Tagore** (1917); Malang Baba/Naked Baba - by **Kabailies** (1930) ; Half-naked Saint/Traitor Faqir - by **Winston Churchill** (1931); Rashtrapita (Father of the Nation) - by **Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose** (1944)
- **UNESCO:** Declared October 2 as **International Non-violence Day** (Ahimsa Diwas).
- He founded **All India Anti-Untouchability League** (later All India Harijan Sevak Sangh) on October 30, 1932, in Mumbai, aimed to eradicate untouchability, improve Dalit conditions, promote inter-caste marriages, and establish schools. Gandhi began to use the term "Harijan" to refer to the untouchables, which means "creation of God". [UPSC 2019]

Gandhi's Years in South Africa (1893-1914)

- **1893:** Departed for South Africa
- **1894:** Founded the **Natal Indian Congress**
- **1899:** Established the **Indian Ambulance Corps** during the **Boer Wars**
- **1903:** Launched *Indian Opinion* magazine and **Phoenix Farm**
- **1906:** Initiated the first **Satyagraha** against the **Asiatic Ordinance** in Transvaal
- **1907:** Conducted **Satyagraha** against Compulsory Registration and Passes for Asians (The Black Act) in Transvaal.
- **1908:** Imprisoned in Johannesburg (first jail term)

- **1910:** Foundation of Tolstoy Farm (later Gandhi Farm) near Johannesburg
- **1913:** Led **Satyagraha** against non-recognition of non-Christian marriages in Cape Town
- **1914:** Quits South Africa forever and returns to India, Awarded Kaisar-i-Hind for raising an Indian Ambulance Corps during Boer wars.

Active Politics in India (1915-47)

- **1915:** Arrived in Bombay on January 9; founded **Satyagraha Ashram** in Kochrab near Ahmedabad (May 20)
- **1916:** Abstained from active politics; Abstain from active politics (though he attended Lucknow session of INC held in 26-31 Dec, 1916, whereupon **Raj Kumar Shukla**, a cultivator from Bihar, requested him to come to Champaran.
- **1917: Champaran Satyagraha: First Civil Disobedience Movement in India.**
- **Ahmedabad Struggle (Feb 1918):** First use of hunger strike.
- **Kheda Satyagraha (March 1918):** his first Non-Cooperation Movement.
- **April 6, 1919:** Called for **Satyagraha** against the **Rowlatt Act**
- **April 13, 1919:** Returned Bengal's gold medal in protest against the **Jallianwala Bagh massacre**.
- **November, 1919:** Elected president of the **All India Khilafat Conference**.
- **1920-22:** Led the **Non-Cooperation Movement** (**Aug. 1, 1920-Feb. 12, 1922**) post the **Chauri Chaura** incident (Feb 5, 1922). (1st mass movement under Gandhi.)
- **1924: INC Leadership:** Elected president of INC for the first and last time.
- **1925-31: Political Retirement and Resumption:** Retired from active politics in 1925; focused on Congress's constructive program. Resumed politics in 1927.
- **1930-34: Civil Disobedience Movement:** Launched **Dandi March** (Salt Satyagraha) on March 12, 1930. Attended the **Round Table Conference** in London (Sept 7-Dec 1, 1931). Civil Disobedience Movement resumed (Jan 3, 1932-April 7, 1934).

- **1934-40: Second Retirement and Sevagram:** Retired from active politics, established **Sevagram** (Wardha Ashram).
- **1940-42:** Resumed politics; initiated the **Individual Satyagraha Movement**.
- **1942:** Launched the **Quit India Movement** with the slogan “Do or Die” (Aug 9)
- **1942-44:** Detained at **Aga Khan Palace** (Aug 9, 1942 - May 6, 1944) Pune along with his wife Kasturba (Feb. 22, 1944) and private secretary Mahadev Desai; his last prison term.
- **1945-46:** Noticed a decline in his influence within Congress, distressed by communal violence, as a result Muslim League’s Direct Action call, Gandhi travelled to Noakhali (East Bengal - now Bangladesh) and later on to Calcutta to restore communal peace.
- **1947:** Distressed by the **Mountbatten Plan** (Partition Plan, June 3), Observed silence at India’s Independence (Aug 15) & Travel to **Delhi** (Sep 1947).
- **1948: Assassination:** Assassinated by **Nathu Ram Godse** while on his way to the evening prayer meeting at Birla House, New Delhi (Jan. 30, 1948), uttering “**Hey Ram.**”

South Africa Episode (1893-1914)

- **Arrival and Motivation (1893):** Gandhi arrived in **Pretoria** in 1893 for a case with **Dada Abdullah**. Witnessing racial discrimination, he stayed to organise Indians against **denied voting rights** and poor conditions.
- **Community Organization:** Gandhi established the **Natal Indian Congress** and **Indian Opinion**. He demanded rights like **first-class tickets** and better accommodations, using his **British education**.
- **Understanding Discrimination:** Gandhi identified **racial superiority**, not a lack of Westernization, as the cause of oppression. His communication skills made him the leader despite being the only **Western-educated Indian**.
- **Moderate Phase (1894-1906):** Gandhi petitioned **South African legislatures**, **Colonial Secretary**, and **British Parliament**. By 1906, he shifted to a more assertive strategy.
- **Satyagraha Phase (1906-1914)**
- **Satyagraha Adoption (1906):** Gandhi launched **nonviolent resistance** in 1906, beginning with the **registration certificate protest** on **Sept 11, 1906**.
 - **Migration Restrictions:** Protests against **Indian migration laws** led to **civil disobedience**.
 - **Poll Tax & Marriage Invalidation:** Resistance against the **three-pound poll tax** and invalidation of **Hindu, Muslim, and Parsi marriages**.
 - **Transvaal Immigration Act:** Gandhi led **Satyagrahis** including **Kasturba**, crossing borders and facing arrests.
- **Compromise Solution:** After negotiations, the government accepted demands on the **poll tax**, **registration certificates**, and **Indian marriages**.

- **Tolstoy Farm (1910):** Tolstoy Farm (1910), founded by Gandhi, was inspired by **Leo Tolstoy** and promoted **self-sustainability** and **social service**. It followed **Phoenix Farm** (1904) and operated until **1913**.
- **Gandhi’s Technique of Satyagraha:** Developed in **South Africa**, Satyagraha combined **Indian traditions**, **Christian teachings**, and **Tolstoy’s philosophy**. It emphasises **truth**, **non-violence**, and **fearlessness** in opposing injustice. Methods include **boycotts**, **non-payment of taxes**, and **refusal of authority**. Satyagrahis embrace **suffering** without hatred, demonstrating **courage**, **strength**, and unity of thought and action.

GANDHI IN INDIA

- **Return:** Gandhi returned to India in **January 1915**, receiving a warm welcome during the **Kumbh Mela** at **Haridwar**.
- **Reputation:** His activism in **South Africa** earned him recognition as a **hero** and **martyr** among Indians.
- **Tour:** Spent a year touring India to understand the **masses** without taking a political stance.
- **Ashram:** Organised his **ashram** in **Ahmedabad** to promote community living.
- **Moderate Politics:** Sceptical of **moderate politics**, he opposed the **Home Rule movement** during **World War I**.

Champaran Satyagraha (1917): First Civil Disobedience

- **Issue:** Farmers in **Champaran, Bihar**, were exploited by indigo planters through the **Tinkathia system**, which required them to cultivate indigo on **3/20** of their land. [UPSC, 2020]
- **Tinkathia system:** The Champaran narrative unfolded in the early 19th century when European planters entrapped cultivators in agreements compelling them to cultivate indigo on the **3/20th** of their land (known as the tinkathia system).
- **Joining of peasant unrest to India’s National Movement** is a very significant aspect of the Champaran Satyagraha [UPSC 2018]
- **Gandhi’s Invitation:** Local leader **Rajkumar Shukla** urged Gandhi to investigate the situation, later joined by notable leaders **Rajendra Prasad**, **Mazharul-Haq**, **Mahadev Desai**, **Narhari Parekh**, and **J.B. Kripalani**.
- **Arrival:** Upon reaching Champaran, Gandhi faced an order to leave but chose to defy it, demonstrating civil disobedience against unjust authority—an uncommon act compared to previous leaders like **Tilak** and **Annie Besant**, who complied with expulsion orders.
- **Inquiry:** After initial resistance, Gandhi was permitted to conduct an inquiry with a government-appointed committee, gathering evidence from **8,000 peasants**.
- **Demands:** He successfully argued for the **abolition of the tinkathia system** and sought compensation for the unlawfully extracted dues.

- **Compensation Agreement:** Gandhi negotiated **25% compensation** for the farmers, leading to the eventual departure of planters from the area within a decade.
- **Significance:** This marked Gandhi's first victory in the civil disobedience movement in India, establishing a precedent for future non-violent resistance.
- **Other Leaders:** Key figures involved included **Brajkishore Prasad, Anugrah Narayan Sinha, Ramnavmi Prasad, and Shambhusharan Varma.**

Ahmedabad Mill Strike (February 1918):

First Hunger Strike

- **Dispute:** A conflict arose between **cotton mill owners** and **workers** over the **withdrawal of the plague bonus.**
- **Context:** Workers sought a **50% wage increase** due to wartime inflation, while mill owners offered only a **20% increase.**
- **Request for Help:** **Anusuya Sarabhai**, sister of mill owner **Ambalal Sarabhai**, sought Gandhi's intervention to mediate the dispute.
- **Advocacy:** Gandhi, despite his friendship with Ambalal, supported the workers' cause, suggesting a **35% wage increase** instead of the original 50%.
- **Escalation:** Tensions heightened as workers faced **dismissals**, and mill owners attempted to replace them with weavers from Bombay.
- **Non-violent Approach:** Gandhi urged the workers to conduct a **non-violent strike**, reinforcing the importance of peaceful protest.
- **Fast unto Death:** As workers grew weary and attendance at meetings declined, Gandhi undertook a **hunger strike** to rally their spirits and emphasise his commitment, promising to starve first if necessary.
- **Impact:** His fast applied pressure on the mill owners to address the situation seriously.
- **Tribunal Settlement:** The mill owners eventually agreed to submit the issue to a tribunal.
- **Outcome:** The tribunal ruled in favour of the workers, granting them a **35% wage hike** and marking a significant victory for non-violent labour protests in India.

Kheda Satyagraha (March 1918):

First Non-Cooperation Movement

- **Issue:** Severe **crop failure** and **drought** in Kheda, Gujarat, led to peasants refusing to pay land revenue taxes.
- **Government Response:** Despite petitions for remission based on the Revenue Code, the government threatened property seizure for non-payment. The Administration did not suspend the land revenue collection in spite of a drought. (UPSC 2011)
- **Gandhi's Role:** Gandhi served as the **spiritual leader**, advocating for non-payment of taxes.
- **Sardar Patel's Leadership:** Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel and dedicated Gandhians, including **Narahari Parikh,**

Mohanlal Pandya, and Ravi Shankar Vyas, provided practical leadership, organising villagers and mobilising support.

- **Support:** The revolt garnered backing from diverse ethnic and caste groups in Kheda, showcasing remarkable **discipline and unity.**
- **Social Solidarity:** Gujaratis from other regions aided the cause, sheltering families and property of protesting farmers, while those buying confiscated lands faced social ostracism.
- **Resolution:** The government eventually agreed to suspend land taxes for the current and following year, reducing the increase in tax rates.
 - Return all confiscated property.
- **Gains from Champaran, Ahmedabad and Kheda:** Champaran, Ahmedabad, and Kheda acted as live demonstrations of Gandhiji's political style and methodology nationwide.

ROWLATT ACT

Introduction: The Rowlatt Act was introduced in March 1919, just before the

Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms. It was based on the recommendations of the **Sedition Committee.** [UPSC 2015]

- **Official Name:** Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act.
- **Purpose:** To empower the British government with extraordinary powers to suppress dissent and quell political unrest in India.
- In Rowlatt Satyagraha, Gandhiji tried to utilise the Home Rule League. [UPSC 2015]
- **Rowlatt Commission:** Established to investigate alleged 'seditious conspiracy.' It recommended severe measures, including the deportation or imprisonment of activists without trial.
- **Key Provisions:** Imprisonment without trial and summary procedures for trial [UPSC 2012]
 - Trials without juries.
 - Arrests without warrants on suspicion of treason.
 - Suspension of **Habeas Corpus.**
 - Secret trials with no legal assistance.
- **Opposition:** The Act faced unanimous opposition from all elected Indian members of the **Imperial Legislative Council**, including prominent figures like **Mohammed Ali Jinnah, Madan Mohan Malaviya, and Mazhar Ul Haq.** In protest, they resigned their positions.
- **Impact:** The Act imposed permanent wartime restrictions on freedom of speech and assembly, reinstating control over the press and government powers to combat perceived terrorism and revolutionary tactics. Gandhi denounced the Act as the "Black Act," leading to widespread protests, including a nationwide **hartal** (strike) launched on **April 6, 1919.**

Satyagraha Against the Rowlatt Act:

The First Mass Strike

- In light of the government's oppressive measures, Gandhi called for mass protests and civil disobedience, urging the involvement of the broader population.
- He utilised political networks such as the **Home Rule Leagues**, **Pan-Islamist groups**, and the **Satyagraha Sabha**.
- **Launch Date:** April 6, 1919, marked the beginning of the Satyagraha. However, it faced large-scale violent demonstrations in cities like **Calcutta**, **Bombay**, **Delhi**, and **Ahmedabad**. [UPSC 2015]
- **Preceding Violence:** A hartal on March 30 in Delhi resulted in considerable violence, setting a precedent for unrest in other regions. The Punjab region experienced heightened tensions due to wartime repression, forced recruitment, and disease.

Government Repression: The protests led to a violent crackdown by the government, with reports of severe repression, including the use of aircraft by **Sir Michael O'Dwyer**, the Lieutenant Governor of Punjab, against protestors. Gandhi attempted to travel to Punjab to calm the situation but was deported to Bombay. Upon arrival, he found turmoil in Bombay and his native **Gujarat**, leading him to stay and address the unrest.

JALLIANWALA BAGH MASSACRE (APRIL 13, 1919)

- **Context:** Amritsar faced significant unrest due to growing discontent with British rule, demonstrated by shop closures and halted trade.
- **Provocation:** On April 9, British officials arrested nationalist leaders **Saifuddin Kitchlew** and **Dr. Satyapal**, leading to widespread protests.
- **Violent Protests:** On April 10, protests turned violent when police fired on demonstrators, prompting troop deployment led by **Brigadier-General Reginald Dyer** to enforce martial law.
- **Dyer's Proclamation: April 13 Orders:** Dyer issued a proclamation prohibiting gatherings, demonstrations, and assemblies of more than three individuals, requiring passes for movement within the city.
- **Gathering:** On **Baisakhi day**, a large crowd gathered at Jallianwala Bagh, unaware of prohibitory orders, to celebrate and pass resolutions against the Rowlatt Act and the April 10 firing.
- **The Shooting:** Dyer ordered his troops to fire into the unarmed crowd, which included men, women, and children. Official British sources reported **379 deaths** and about **1,100 injuries**, while the Indian National Congress estimated over **1,000 deaths** and **1,500 injuries**. Over **1,650 bullets** were fired into the crowd.

- **Martial Law:** Following the massacre, martial law was declared in Punjab, leading to brutal reprisals against the population, including public floggings and other inhumane treatments.
- **National Reaction:** The massacre shocked the nation, prompting **Rabindranath Tagore** to renounce his knighthood and **Gandhi** to surrender his **Kaiser-i-Hind** title.
- **Gandhi's Withdrawal:** Overwhelmed by the violence, Gandhi withdrew the Rowlatt Satyagraha on **April 18, 1919**, realising that cooperation with the British regime was impossible. He called his initial approach a "Himalayan Blunder" but maintained faith in non-violent Satyagraha and the Indian people's capacity for peaceful resistance.

Hunter Committee (1919-1920)

- **Triggered by:** **Jallianwala Bagh massacre** (April 1919), **Edwin Montagu** established the **Hunter Committee** on **October 14, 1919**.
- **Chairman:** **Lord William Hunter**.
- **Purpose:** Investigate disturbances in **Bombay**, **Delhi**, and **Punjab**.
- **Indian Members:** **Sir Chimanlal Setalvad**, **Pandit Jagat Narayan**, **Sardar Sahibzada Sultan Ahmad Khan**.
- **Inquiry:** Started **October 29, 1919**, in **Delhi**; moved to **Lahore** by **November**.
- **Report (March 1920):** Condemned **Dyer** for firing without warning, prolonged firing, and exceeding authority. A **minority report** criticised Dyer's actions as **inhuman**.
- **Outcome:** No penalties due to the **Indemnity Act**.
- **Public Reaction:** **Churchill** condemned Dyer, leading to his **dismissal** in **March 1920**. **Support from House of Lords** and **Golden Temple** recognition.
- **Congress Response:** Formed a committee (including **Motilal Nehru**, **C.R. Das**, **Gandhi**) to criticise Dyer and oppose **martial law** in **Punjab**.

NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT AND KHILAFAT ISSUE

The **Rowlatt Act**, the **Jallianwala Bagh massacre**, and the imposition of **martial law in Punjab** shattered British wartime promises, deepening disillusionment among Indian Muslims, who felt manipulated regarding Turkey's treatment post-World War I. Between **1919 and 1922**, the British faced opposition from two mass movements: the **Khilafat Movement** and the **Non-Cooperation Movement**. Despite different origins, both adopted nonviolent non-cooperation, fostering **Hindu-Muslim unity** against British rule.

The Khilafat Issue: The Khilafat issue arose from British mistreatment of Turkey, angering Indian Muslims who viewed the Sultan as their spiritual leader.

- **Causes of Discontent**

- **Economic Hardships:** Rising prices, decreased industrial output, and increased taxes fueled anti-British sentiment.
- **Repressive Measures:** The **Rowlatt Act**, martial law, and the Jallianwala Bagh massacre highlighted the brutal nature of British rule.
- **Flawed Inquiry:** The **Hunter Committee** was criticised for ineffectiveness, with the House of Lords supporting General Dyer's actions and raising funds for him.
- **Inadequate Reforms:** The **Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms** of 1919 failed to meet Indian demands for self-government, increasing dissatisfaction.
- By early **1920**, the justifications for British rule were waning, facilitating political unity among Hindus and Muslims.

- **Key Factors for Political Unity**

- **Lucknow Pact (1916):** Fostered cooperation between the **Congress** and the **Muslim League**.
- **Rowlatt Act Agitation:** Unified various societal segments in protest against imperialism.
- **Rise of Radical Nationalists:** Leaders like **Mohammad Ali** and **Abul Kalam Azad** promoted militant nationalism, overshadowing conservative factions.

- **Khilafat Committee Formation (1919)**

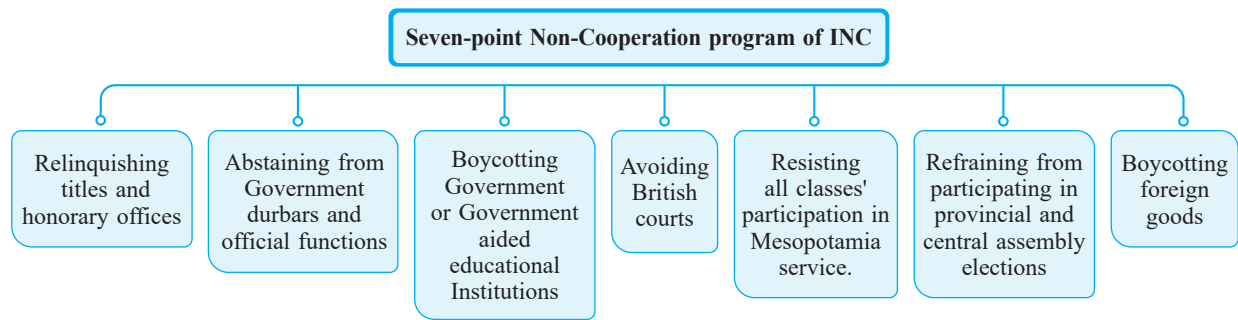
- **Background:** Post-WWI, **Muslims** angered by **British mistreatment** of Turkey, viewed **Sultan (Khalifa)** as spiritual leader.
- **Demands:** Retention of **Khalifa's control** over sacred places, adequate territories for him.
- **Khilafat Committee:** Formed in **early 1919** by **Ali brothers** (Shaukat, Muhammad Ali), **Maulana Azad**, **Ajmal Khan**, **Hasrat Mohani** to pressure the British.
- **Khilafat-Non-Cooperation Programme:** Peaceful actions to **militant stance—boycott British goods** (All India Khilafat Conference, **Nov 1919**).
- **Gandhi's Role:** As **President**, saw movement's potential for **non-cooperation** against **British**, threatened withdrawal if Turkey's peace terms unfavourable.

- **Congress's Stand on the Khilafat Question:** The Congress's position was crucial for the Khilafat movement's success: Gandhi advocated for satyagraha and non-cooperation on the Khilafat issue, but the Congress was initially divided. **Tilak** opposed aligning with Muslim leaders over a religious matter and questioned the

effectiveness of satyagraha. Gandhi worked to convince him and others, eventually securing Congress's approval for his non-cooperation program, which included support for the Khilafat issue.

The Non-Cooperation Movement

- **February 1920:** A joint **Hindu-Muslim** deputation seeking redress for the **Khilafat** issue fails. Gandhi emphasises that the **Punjab wrongs** are overshadowed by Khilafat concerns and hints at a non-cooperation movement if peace treaty terms fail.
- **May 1920:** The **Treaty of Sevres** dismembers Turkey, worsening the Khilafat issue.
- **June 1920:** An all-party conference in **Allahabad** endorses a boycott of educational and legal institutions and calls for Gandhi's leadership.
- **August 1, 1920:** The movement was formally initiated after the lapse of Gandhi's notice to the Viceroy. He asserts the right of subjects to withdraw support from a mis-ruling government. Notably, **B.G. Tilak** passed away on this date.
- **September 1920:** Congress approves a non-cooperation program addressing **Punjab** and **Khilafat** issues and establishes **Swaraj**.
- **Nagpur Session (December 1920):**
 - Congress adopts **Non-Violent Non-Cooperation** against unjust governance and shifts focus towards **Swaraj**.
 - A new Congress Constitution emphasises **peaceful methods** and a modern organisational structure, culminating in the **All India Congress Committee** of 350 members and a **Working Committee** of 15.
- **Organisational Changes:** The **Provincial Congress Committees** are restructured by language to enhance local communication. The annual membership fee is reduced to **four annas** to encourage participation and streamline operations. **Hindi** is prioritised in communications.
- **Khilafat Committee and Congress Initiatives:** The **Khilafat Committee** and Congress unite for **Non-Cooperation** with three objectives (Address the **Khilafat issue**, Rectify **Punjab's wrongs**, & Achieve **Swaraj**.) In a June 1920 meeting, the Khilafat Committee outlined a **four-stage non-cooperation** plan, including resigning from honorary titles, civil services, police, and military positions, and refusing to pay taxes.
- **Seven-Point Non-Cooperation Program: September 1920:** The Indian National Congress presents a **seven-point program**, including:



- Gandhi's tours inspire public support, resulting in about **30,000 arrests** in 1921. While some leaders initially resist the boycott of councils, they ultimately align with Congress discipline
- **Response from Various Groups:** The non-cooperation movement invigorates popular participation in **1921** and **1922**. Revolutionary groups, particularly from **Bengal**, support the Congress initiative. Leaders like **Mohammad Ali Jinnah** and **Annie Besant** distance themselves from Congress, advocating for constitutional approaches. Meanwhile, **Surendranath Banerjea** forms the **Indian National Liberal Federation**, which plays a minor role in national politics.

Spread of the Non-Cooperation Movement

- **Nationwide Tour:** Gandhi, alongside the Ali brothers, led a nationwide tour to mobilise support.
- **Educational Boycott:** Thousands of students left government schools, joining around **800 national schools** and colleges, such as **Jamia Millia**, **Kashi Vidyapeeth**, and **Bihar Vidyapeeth**, under the leadership of figures like **Acharya Narendra Dev**, **C.R. Das**, and **Subhash Bose**.
- **Professional Participation:** Prominent lawyers, including **Motilal Nehru**, **Jawaharlal Nehru**, **C.R. Das**, and **Vallabhbhai Patel**, abandoned their legal practices. Public demonstrations, such as the burning of foreign cloth, significantly reduced imports, while picketing targeted shops selling foreign liquor. The **Tilak Swaraj Fund** raised over **one crore rupees**.
- **Congress Volunteer Corps:** Functioning as a parallel police force, the Congress Volunteer Corps posed a challenge to the government. In **July 1921**, the Ali brothers called for Muslims to resign from the army for religious reasons, resulting in their arrest in September. Gandhi supported this initiative, urging local Congress committees to pass similar resolutions.
- **Civil Disobedience:** The visit of the **Prince of Wales** in **November 1921** incited strikes and demonstrations across the country. Provincial Congress Committees (PCCs) were empowered to approve mass civil disobedience, intensifying the movement.
- **Protests and Strikes: Regional Dynamics**
 - In **Midnapur**, a cultivators' strike against a White Zamindari company gained traction.
 - Regions in **Andhra** saw no-tax movements defying forest laws, while in **Punjab**, the **Akali Movement** aimed to gain control of gurudwaras from corrupt mahants, adhering to non-violence amid significant repression.
 - **Assam** experienced labour strikes on tea plantations and transport services, led by figures like **J.M. Sengupta**.
 - In **Avadh**, the existing Kisan movement was invigorated by Non-Cooperation propaganda from leaders like **Jawaharlal Nehru**. This led to overlaps between Non-Cooperation and Kisan meetings.
 - In **Malabar**, Kerala, Non-Cooperation and Khilafat efforts incited Muslim tenants against landlords, occasionally straying into communal tensions.
- **People's Response to the Non-Cooperation Movement**
 - **Middle Class:** Initially led by the middle class, scepticism arose in elite centres like Calcutta, Bombay, and Madras regarding Gandhi's calls to resign from government roles. Leaders like **Rajendra Prasad** and **Vallabhbhai Patel** viewed non-cooperation as a viable alternative to terrorism.
 - **Business Class:** The economic boycott gained support, benefiting many Indian businesses through **Swadeshi**. However, larger businesses were cautious due to fears of labour unrest.
 - **Peasants:** Peasants played a crucial role, merging class struggles with the Non-Cooperation agenda, particularly in Bihar, where they rose against landlords.
 - **Students:** Actively engaged, students left government schools for national institutions like **Kashi Vidyapeeth**.
 - **Women:** Women abandoned purdah, contributed to the **Tilak Fund**, and participated in picketing foreign goods.
 - **Hindu-Muslim Unity:** Despite incidents like the **Moplah Uprisings**, Muslim participation was significant, with many arrests involving Muslims, supported by Gandhi's outreach to communities.

- **Government Response**

- **May 1921 Talks Breakdown:** Negotiations between Gandhi and Viceroy **Reading** failed when the government sought to curb violent rhetoric from the Ali brothers.
- **December 1921 Crackdown:** The government declared volunteer corps illegal, banned public gatherings, imposed press censorship, and arrested most leaders, except Gandhi.

- **Last Phase of the Movement**

- **Pressure for Civil Disobedience:** In 1921, pressure mounted for Gandhi to initiate civil disobedience.
- **Ahmedabad Session (1921):** Presided over by **C.R. Das** (in jail), this session designated Gandhi as the sole authority on civil disobedience.
- **Gandhi's Threat:** On **February 1, 1922**, from Bardoli, Gandhi threatened civil disobedience unless political prisoners were released and press restrictions lifted, but the movement was soon halted.

Chauri Chaura Incident (February 5, 1922)

- **Location:** Chauri-Chaura, Gorakhpur district.
- **Inciting Event:** Police violently confronted volunteers protesting against liquor sales and high food prices.
- **Violent Outburst:** The crowd retaliated by attacking the police station, resulting in the deaths of **twenty-two policemen**.

Reasons for Withdrawal of the Non-Cooperation Movement

- **Loss of Relevance:** The Khilafat issue diminished after Mustafa Kamal Pasha's rise in Turkey (1922), leading to the abolition of the caliphate in 1924 and Turkey's transformation into a secular state.

- **Public Sentiment:** Gandhi believed halting the movement at its peak was detrimental. He feared that violence, exemplified by Chauri Chaura, could lead to repression by the colonial government.
- **Revolutionary Unrest:** Growing revolutionary sentiments and labour unrest pressured leaders to adopt a more radical approach, which Gandhi sought to control.
- **Fatigue:** Signs of fatigue were evident, with a decline in mass enthusiasm and the government's refusal to negotiate.
- **Bardoli Resolution (February 1922):** The (CWC) committee resolved to halt law-breaking and focus on constructive initiatives like khadi promotion, national schools, and Hindu-Muslim unity.
- **Gandhi's Arrest:** Gandhi was sentenced to six years in prison in March 1922, where he emphasised his commitment to resisting injustice.

Diverse Views on the Incident

- **Subhas Chandra Bose:** Viewed the withdrawal as a national calamity.
- **Marxist Interpretation:** Interpreted the withdrawal as an effort to control revolutionary potential.
- **Signs of Fatigue:** Late 1921 showed decreased enthusiasm and attendance, indicating movement fatigue.
- **Strategic Withdrawal:** Gandhi's decision was seen as a necessary retreat to regroup and prepare for future struggles, rather than a betrayal.

Evaluation of the Khilafat Non-Cooperation Movement: The Khilafat Non-Cooperation Movement engaged urban Muslims but fueled communalism, complicating the secular struggle. It politicised diverse groups, instilled a revolutionary spirit, and challenged colonial myths, reducing fear of repression. However, it struggled to shift Muslim political focus from religion to secularism, and critics argued it prioritised Islamic over national interests, fostering communal divisions.

